

Question to the pros: how will the world be able to provide all energy needed for AI/AGI moving forward?

Posted by u/angeluccig • 0 points • 38 comments

A while back I saw an interview from Sam Altman where he said the cost of AI at some point will be basically the energy cost for it. But that made me think, does the world have enough “dry powder” to cover for its needs?

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-03-21 10:29 UTC

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u/CodeCharacter1717 • 1 points • 2026-03-19 18:24 UTC

AI robs earth of its energy and human of their jobs. All for what? I understand the proposition of better drug discovery and gene sequencing. other than those, I don't see any more good coming out of it.

u/Educational-Money889 • 1 points • 2026-03-18 07:57 UTC

AI is impossible in a finite world. AI is possible in an energy and stable environment with infinite resources and we are running out of all three. AI is the wet dream of rich elites and desperate countries. With less oil, we will have economic depression, with polluted environment we will have wars for water and food, everything will become so absurdly expensive that we will switch to jobs that maintain life. Unless AI can make appear food and winters and fish it is a wasted tech. With energy shortage, computers and internet which require supervision and constant reparation might not be constant, so if AI survives, it will be very niche for very specific use.

u/International-Bus606 • 1 points • 2026-03-17 14:59 UTC

Funny how they dropped all the Climate Change nonsense once they got behind AI as a way to control the populace.

u/dacrispystonah • 1 points • 2025-12-23 14:08 UTC

Infinite growth in a finite system. What could possibly go wrong?

u/Laura_has_Secrets77 • 1 points • 2025-11-05 16:10 UTC

I've been to many AI events with "experts" and I've yet to see an honest answer beyond "solar energy!" Which doesn't really compete with fossil fuel. Plus, what people want done with AI is infinite production but those need planetary resources that are finite and running out. It's frustrating to me how this question is considered controversial.

u/Delicious_Spot_3778 • 1 points • 2025-08-09 03:44 UTC

It's obviously a constraint that the industry hasn't faces yet

u/nebulousmenace • 3 points • 2025-08-08 02:24 UTC

1. If Sam Altman told me I was alive, I'd check my pulse. The guy is so full of shit he's pressurized.
2. Most of the server farms are vaporware. For one thing the number of chips we can produce is, like, ten times lower than the alleged server farm demand. Right now there's very little downside to pretending you're going to build six server farms in six different places and just building with the people that give you the best deal.
3. I know I already said Sam Altman was full of shit but the entire premise of the "AI revolution" is based on a lie. If you had an assistant who was right, generously, 85% of the time you'd have to spend just as much time checking their work as you'd have to spend doing the work yourself. The whole LLM algorithm isn't even aiming to be correct. It's the thing after crypto, the thing after NFTs, the thing where it's easier to scam investors than it is to build something people want. I could keep going...

u/Reboot-Glitchspark • 2 points • 2025-09-04 00:04 UTC

You forgot to mention that Sam Altman babbles whatever nonsense might convince some people to throw money at him.

But aside from that, the AI buildout happening now is massive and unsustainable. It's got negative ROI, and no clear path to a positive ROI. You would need to charge half the entire population of the world (men, women, and children) a significant subscription fee just to break even. And - importantly - all of those systems being built out, well they're all gonna be obsolete in just a few years. Before they get any ROI.

If Sam Altman says otherwise, well, what do you expect from someone trying to scam you?

Sure, a few companies might make bank on it eventually, after the other 97% crash. Maybe.

u/RespectSquare8279 • 0 points • 2025-08-07 19:38 UTC

There are actually no accurate measurements or published figures of total of electrical consumption in server farms today. There are only estimates.

u/Cominginbladey • 1 points • 2025-08-07 19:07 UTC

The problem is that nobody really knows what the need will actually be. Right now AI developers are going to five different utilities with a speculative project. Then all five utilities are putting that need in their load forecasts. The RTOs, driven by their utility members, are fanning the hype and utilities are using the hype to build new power plants to serve data centers that may not even materialize. There is a new report out saying that there aren't enough microchips available to build all the data centers that developers are proposing.

u/xylopyrography • 1 points • 2025-08-07 19:36 UTC

That's what I've been thinking about for nearly a year now... people keep investing more and more money, but only so many GPUs on cutting-edge nodes can be made and what can be made in 2030 is basically already set in stone.

Sure capacity can be increased, if chip makers can find significant amounts of new talent that want to work in semiconductor manufacturing, but we're talking about increasing capacity for 2032 and beyond.

